

END OF SHOPEE-ING

Singapore's Sea Ltd has closed India operations of its e-commerce arm Shopee, less than six months after making an ambitious launch. While the company blamed global market uncertainties, there might be more to it than meets the eye, especially since India banned Sea's popular game *Free Fire* for its Chinese links. Sea's withdrawal is also triggered by the high cash burn rates to establish an e-commerce venture in India.

—BINU PAUL



Home, Costly Home

THAT HOME YOU'VE BEEN eyeing could cost you a fair bit more than what you'd bargained for. Why? Cost of key construction materials is surging, ergo home prices are also expected to follow suit. Estimates by professional services and investment management company Colliers say prices of raw materials have risen significantly by end-March over March 2021—steel (30 per cent), cement (22 per cent), copper (40 per cent) and aluminium (44 per cent). As a result, the average cost of construction for residential units has grown 12 per cent, and 11 per cent for industrial. Now you know why you'll have to shell out more.

—ARNAB DUTTA



SUPER TATA

With the launch of 'super app' Tata Neu, India's oldest business group has taken a giant step in the digital economy. With an array of consumer-facing brands, a person downloading this super app can avail a host of services. Booking a ticket on Air India, purchasing electronics at Croma or picking up grocery items off bigbasket, ordering a cup of coffee at Starbucks or getting medicines delivered at home through Tata 1mg are just some of the options.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



14 |

PLI AHoy!

The government's production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for medical devices has got off to a flying start. Wipro GE Healthcare inaugurated a ₹100-crore facility in Bengaluru for manufacturing CT machines, cath lab equipment, ultrasound scanners, patient monitoring solutions, ECG machines and ventilators. And Siemens Healthineers has set up a new production line of CT scanners, also in Bengaluru, to expand its manufacturing footprint. The scheme has a financial outlay of ₹3,420 crore for 2020-21 to 2027-28.

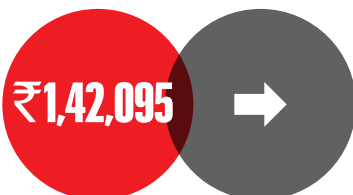
—NIDHI SINGAL

TIGHTER RULES FOR CIS

Collective investment schemes or CIS, wherein a group of people pool money to invest in an asset, would be subject to more stringent norms—on par with mutual funds—with stock market regulator Sebi deciding to tighten the regulatory framework for CIS. It has enhanced the net worth criteria and made it mandatory for

the company to have a track record in the CIS space. Such firms will also need to meet norms of minimum number of investors, maximum holding of a single investor, and minimum subscription amount. Sebi will also bring in more transparency in the fee and expense structure of CIS entities.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR



CRORE THE RECORD GROSS GST (GOODS AND SERVICES TAX) COLLECTION IN MARCH 2022, THE HIGHEST EVER. IT BREACHED THE PREVIOUS HIGH OF ₹1,40,986 CRORE, COLLECTED IN JANUARY 2022